

What is Cloud Computing?

Back in the day, the average organization would be required to purchase a whole bunch of computers, associated softwares. With time the software would go out of date because of which the head of IT would be left with two problems in his hands. The first being that he now needs to update the software on every single computer (while remembering to factor in the fact that new employees will be joining the organization) and the second being the fact that chances are, the old computers might not have the necessary specs to run the new softwares, meaning another upgrade.

With cloud computing, the problem is solved. In theory at least. In cloud computing, the software and the hardware required to run it are on somebody else's server. All you will be required to do is run install an application that serves as the interface to the service. The server does all the processing and saves your data, while your computer only needs enough resources to run and display the interface which could be done with just a web browser.

As I type this article on Google Drive, a server that probably half way across the world is computing every keystroke and displaying them on my screen. My computer doesn't need to worry about running a heavy word processor and doesn't turn the heat up to eleven and try to cook my thighs. The point is, with cloud computing, your computer doesn't have to pull the weights and work overtime. Somebody else's computer does that for you.

This brings us to the next question- Why was there a sudden burst of cloud base applications and where has it been all this while?

Well, it's been around for quite a while. In fact most popular e-mail services are cloud based as your mails are all stored off shore and the whole sending and receiving has been carried out by a server. The earliest reference to cloud computing was in the 50's where computers, used in academics and by corporations would be accessible via terminals which would only serve as a connection to the computer and would compute anything on their own. As a sort of return on investment, these computers were accessed via these terminals, thus laying down the foundations for cloud based computing. With better internet speeds and stability, the idea of cloud OSes is in the process of taking off.

How does an OS work on cloud?

The first thing you need to know about Chrome OS is that it's a cloud based operating system. What are they you ask? While the operating systems on most computers works off the computer's hard drive, a Cloud OS or a